Start with what you already have

Set up a search from your experience and preferences, then improve it from the results. Use this guide on its own or with the free Job Search Starter. Choose either route: your own AI on page 2, or a manual search on page 3.

Already have a summary

Reuse your experience and preferences summary from an earlier conversation or your own notes. If you use the starter site, choose “I have a summary” and paste it. You do not need to copy it into separate fields.

Starting from scratch

Fill in the short brief below in your own notes. Start with the work that interests you and where you would work; add relevant experience and scope. If you use the starter site, choose “Help me build my brief” to enter those details there.

Your short search brief

Work I want to explore: [responsibilities or directions]
Where I would work: [location or remote region]
Relevant experience: [short summary, if available]
Must meet: [firm requirements, if any]
Would prefer: [choices that could flex]
Optional starting points: [titles, sources, employers or saved openings]

Choose how to search

- Search yourself: take your summary or brief to page 3 and run the searches yourself. On the site, choose “Build my search plan” for query links and a plan. Those links need a short work direction and location, even if you pasted a summary.
- Use your own AI: copy the prompt on page 2 and add your summary or brief, then send it to an assistant with current web access. Or choose “Prepare my prompt” on the site; your summary alone is enough.

Keep the first search simple

You can start without choosing every title, source or employer. A requirement must be met; a preference can trade off. Keep unclear conditions unconfirmed. The starter prepares instructions and query links; you or your chosen assistant run the search. Keep confidential work and other people’s private information out of anything you share.

Open the Job Search Starter

Ask your AI to run a first search

Send this prompt with your summary or brief to an assistant with current web access. The starter can prepare it for you. If the assistant cannot browse, use page 3.

Copy this prompt and add your starting point

Use my summary or brief below to find current openings. Start from my experience, responsibilities and scope. Suggest a few related titles or work phrases, explain why, and test them against actual descriptions.

Ask about missing details that would materially change the search; otherwise mark them unknown and proceed. Keep firm requirements separate from preferences. Do not invent experience or treat an unmentioned skill as a missing ability.

Search employer careers pages, broad and specialist job boards, and the wider web. Find suitable sources if I have not named any. Include saved openings, alerts and recruiter leads I provide; do not assume access to my accounts. State the scope searched and any sources inaccessible or unchecked.

Find each promising vacancy on the employer's site and read the full description. Check for a current vacancy listing or working application form. A description alone does not confirm availability; broken links or conflicting evidence remain unverified. Keep unverified leads separate and explain what needs checking.

Explain relevance from the actual work and scope. Exclude only confirmed failures of firm requirements, showing why; silence about a requirement does not mean it is met. Keep preferences flexible and unknowns visible.

Combine duplicate copies of one vacancy, keeping different jobs at the same employer separate. Retain still-active saved openings. Where history allows, distinguish new, repeated and changed results, and keep applied or declined roles separate. Say if history is unavailable.

For each lead, give employer, title, job ID if available, employer link, discovery source, date checked and availability evidence. Include the work, location, arrangement, posted pay and its basis, relevance, unknowns and next action. Do not guess bonus or equity. Distinguish no relevant results from an incomplete search. Do not apply or contact anyone.

MY SUMMARY OR BRIEF:
[Provide your starting point here.]

Check the results and explain what missed

Open a few employer links and check the work and conditions. Before preparing an application, compare the exact requirements with your experience. Try feedback such as: "These jobs are mostly booking appointments. I want to coordinate project delivery. Suggest search changes and explain why." Ask for an updated brief with the changes you accept. Bring that brief, useful sources and saved openings into a new chat; do not assume it remembers.

Repeat it when the search is useful

If your assistant supports scheduled web searches, agree on days, time zone and delivery. Check that the task exists and its first run worked. Use your latest brief; recheck postings before acting. The starter cannot create a schedule. Pause tasks when your search ends.

Example scheduling instructions for ChatGPT

Run your first search without AI

Use your brief from page 1. This fictional example follows someone looking for project coordination work. Replace [location] in the searches with a city or region where you would work.

1. Start with the work and a few search terms

Try “project coordinator [location] jobs” and “program coordinator [location] careers”. Use a broad job board or web search, employer careers pages and a specialist board for your field. To find one, try “[field] job board [location]”. Include useful openings people send you.

Read the responsibilities before judging the title. Two “coordinator” jobs can involve very different work.

2. Use the results to make a specific change

Suppose most results involve booking appointments, while your brief describes coordinating projects, timelines and dependencies.

Try “project delivery coordinator [location] jobs” or “implementation coordinator [location] jobs”. Add the kind of projects you want to support, or try a board focused on that field. Read the next results to see whether the change helped.

Do not exclude every posting that mentions appointments. Some scheduling may be part of a relevant job. Keep flexible preferences separate from firm requirements.

3. Check a promising opening with the employer

Find the same vacancy on the employer’s careers site. Read the full description and compare the work, responsibility and conditions with your brief. Check a current vacancy listing or working application form; a description alone does not confirm availability.

An unstated requirement stays a question. Broken links or conflicting information leave the opening unverified. Before preparing an application, compare the requirements with your actual experience; something missing from your summary is not proof you cannot do it.

4. Keep the useful parts for your next search

Keep useful terms and sources with your brief. Save employer links, check dates and questions. Combine duplicate copies of one vacancy, retain still-active saved openings, and note applications or passes. A note can be this simple:

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Search change: try project delivery terms; appointment-heavy results missed the work.
Promising role: [employer link] · checked [check date] · still to ask [question].
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- Save a search or set an alert where offered. Recheck openings before acting; adjust or pause alerts that stop being useful.